

VOCABULARY: Homonyms, Homophones and Homographs**Homonyms**

A 'homonym' is a word that sounds the same or is spelled the same as another word but has a different meaning. Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary defines a homonym as "A word that is spelt like another word (or pronounced like it) but that has a different meaning for example can meaning 'be able' and can meaning 'in a container'."

1. Arms

1. Weapons. For example: *He was trying to rebuild the country's **nuclear arms** programme.*
2. Body part. *My **arms** ache when I lift a heavy bag*

2. Back

1. The rear part of the body. For example: *I **am** suffering from severe **back** ache.*
2. To support something or somebody. For example: *Opposition parties backed Mr Y Sinha during the elections of the President of India.*

3. Body

1. The whole physical structure of a human or an animal. For example: *The **human body** is a complex structure.*
2. A group of people who work or act together, often for an official purpose. For example: *The governing **body** of the school is/are concerned about discipline.*

4. Cast

1. The actors in a film, play, or show. For example: *After the final performance the director threw a party for the **cast**.*
2. To give a vote. For example: *Altogether, 8 votes were **cast**.*

5. Change

1. Become/make different. For example: *Her **life** **changed** completely when she won the lottery.*
2. To exchange money for the same amount in different coins or notes. For example: *Can you **change** a 1000-rupee note?*

6. Cost

1. The amount of money needed to buy something. For example: *It is difficult for most people to deal with the rising **cost** of healthcare.*
2. To cause someone to lose or destroy something valuable: *Drinking and driving **costs** lives.*

7. Ditch

1. A long, narrow open hole that is dug into the ground. For example: *She moved off the road into the **ditch**.*
2. To get rid of something or someone that is no longer wanted: *The thief **ditched** Mani's purse in a dust bin but kept the money.*

8. Draw

1. To make a picture with a pen or a pencil. For example: *Children **drew** pictures of their family members.*
2. A situation, in a game, in which neither side wins. For example: *The result of the match was a **draw**.*

9. Drop

1. To fall or to allow something to fall. For example: *She **dropped** her keys.*
2. A small round-shaped amount of liquid. For example: *I thought I felt a **drop** of rain.*

10. Hand

1. Body part. For example: *Raise your **hand** if you want to ask something.*
2. Help. For example: *Our neighbour is always willing to lend a **hand** whenever we need.*

11. Interest

1. The feeling of wanting to give your attention to something. *My sister takes a lot of **interest** in drawing pictures.*
2. Money that is charged for borrowing money: ***Interest** charges on an overdraft are usually quite high.*

12. Field

SEMESTER: ODD

MODULE: 1

VOCABULARY: Homonyms, Homophones and Homographs

1. The area of land. For example: *The cows were all standing in one corner of the field.*
2. An area of activity, or interest. For example: *Are you still in the same field?*
13. **Foul**
 1. Extremely unpleasant. For example: *The toilet smells foul.*
 2. An act against the rules in sports. For example: *He was sent off the ground for making a foul on the captain.*
14. **Help**
 1. Assistance/ support. For example: *Please tell me how I can help you.*
 2. Someone who is employed to clean and do the other small jobs: *Domestic help assists Rajesh and Ranjita in doing all the household work.*
15. **Lay**
 1. Put somebody down gently. For example: *She laid the baby down gently on the bed.*
 2. Spread. For example: *Before they started eating, they laid the newspaper on the floor.*
16. **Leave**
 1. To go away. For example: *The bus leaves in five minutes.*
 2. Time allowed away from work for a holiday or illness: For example: *I've asked if I can take a week's unpaid leave.*
17. **Palm**
 1. Body part. For example: *I don't believe in palm-reading.*
 2. A kind of tree. For example: *You can find coconut palm in Malaysia.*
18. **Point**
 1. An idea/ opinion, or a piece of information that is said or written. For example: *You made some interesting points in your speech.*
 2. A particular place. For example: *This is a good point from which we can watch the race.*
19. **Sack**
 1. A large bag. For example: *The wheat was stored in large sacks.*
 2. To dismiss someone. For example: *He was sacked for not completing the task on time.*
20. **Safe**
 1. Not in danger or likely to be harmed: *In some cities you don't feel safe going out alone at night.*
 2. A strong box or cupboard with special locks. For example: *Thieves broke into the safe and stole the valuables.*
21. **Shake**
 1. Quick movements. For example: *Shake the bottle before you take the medicine.*
 2. To disturb or upset somebody. For example: *The incident had shaken her faith in him.*
22. **Staff**
 1. The workers employed in an organization. For example: *The hospital staff cared for me so well.*
 2. A long stick used as a support while walking or climbing. For example: *The old man was using a staff while going upstairs.*
23. **Step**
 1. A stage in a process. For example: *What is the next step in the process?*
 2. Stair: *We had to climb several steps to reach the front door.*
24. **Still**
 1. Continuing to happen. *I'm still hungry.*
 2. Not moving: *Children find it difficult to sit/stand/stay still for very long.*
25. **Sound**
 1. Something that you can hear. For example: *They could hear the sound of a bell ringing in the distance.*
 2. To seem good, interesting, strange, etc. For example: *Your job sounds really interesting.*
26. **Subject**
 1. An area of knowledge that is studied in school, college, or university. For example: *My favourite subjects at school were history and English.*

VOCABULARY: Homonyms, Homophones and Homographs

MODULE: I

2. A citizen. For example: *Mr Bob is a British subject.*
27. **Take**
1. to subtract a number. For example: *If you **take** 4 from 12, you get 8.*
 2. An opinion about something. For example: *We'd love to hear your **take** on this issue.*
28. **Trip**
1. A short journey. For example: *Our **trip** to Europe was very exciting.*
 2. To lose balance. For example: *He **tripped** and fell down, grazing his knee.*
29. **Turn**
1. To move in a circle. For example: *He **turned** her on her toes holding her head.*
 2. To change into. For example: *The weather has suddenly **turned** cold.*
30. **Well**
1. In a good way. For example: *Today's **debate** presented both sides very **well**.*
 2. A deep hole in the ground from which you can get water. For example: *Gangai went to Thankur's **well** to fetch water.*

Homophones

A homophone is a word that is pronounced the same as another word but has a different meaning or spelling, or both. Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary defines it as "a word that is pronounced like another word but has a different spelling or meaning, for example plain, plane /pleɪn/."

1. Air/ Heir

Air: The mixture of gases that surrounds the earth and that we breathe. For example: *I went outside to get some fresh **air**.*

Heir: Successors. For example: *Mansi and Gauri are going to be **heirs** to a large fortune.*

2. Arms/ Alms

Arms: Body part. For example: *My sister put her **arms** around my shoulder.*

Alms: Offerings. *The poor old beggar was bagging for **alms**.*

3. Bare, Bear

Bare: Without, naked. For example: *One should not go **bare** footed in the sun.*

Bear: To tolerate. For example: *I can't **bear** separation from my family.*

4. Birth/ Berth

Birth: To be born. For example: *The study of history gave **birth** to the social sciences.*

Berth: Place of sleep in a train. For example: *We got our **berths** reserved in an air conditioned compartment.*

5. Blue/ Blew

Blue: A colour. For example: *The girl was wearing a beautiful **blue** gown.*

Blew: The past tense of the verb

'blow.' For example: *He **blew** his trumpet to make an announcement.*

6. Break/ Brake

Break: To destroy. For example: *The maid dropped the plate and it **broke** into pieces.*

Brake: Device for stopping vehicles. For example: *He applied **brakes** and pulled the car to the side of the road.*

7. Cent/ Scent

Cent: A hundred. For example: *A successful career requires **hundred** percent commitment.*

Scent: Fragrance. For example: *The air was filled with the **scent** of flowers.*

8. Course/ Coarse

Course: Path, direction taken. For example: *The rivers change their **course** with seasons.*

Coarse: Rough. For example: *She found their remarks rather **coarse** and vulgar.*

9. Dear/ Deer

Dear: Loved or liked very much. For example: *She was a very **dear** friend.*

SEMESTER: ODD

MODULE: I

VOCABULARY: Homonyms, Homophones and Homographs

Deer: A large animal. For example: *I saw a big deer near the river.*

10. Days/ Daze

Days: Calendar days. For example: *He has worked days and nights together.*

Daze: In a confused state. For example: *Survivors of the accident were dazed and frightened.*

11. Die/ Dye

Die: Decease. For example: *Doctors said she will die soon as she is suffering from cancer.*

Dye: Colour. For example: *She dyed her hair pink.*

12. Gate/ Gait

Gate: Opening, entrance. For example: *He pushed open the garden gate.*

Gait: Manner of walking. For example: *You should walk with a smart gait.*

13. Hair/ Hare

Hair: Locks. For example: *He smoothed his hair and adjusted his tie.*

Hare: An animal like a large rabbit. For example: *The hare and the tortoise were old friends.*

14. Heel/ Heal

Heel: A part of the foot. For example: *He hurt his heel when he was running.*

Heal: To cure. For example: *Injury is not serious; it will heal soon.*

15. Know/ No

Know: To have information in your mind. For example: *Our teacher knows the name of every student in the class.*

No: Not any. For example: *There are no pockets in these trousers.*

16. Meet/ Meat

Meet: To assemble, get together. For example: *We will meet our old friends today.*

Meat: Flesh that may be eaten. For example: *Being a non-vegetarian, he loves meat, fish and chicken.*

17. Niece/ Knees

Niece: A daughter of your brother or sister. For example: *Mansi is my favourite niece.*

Knees: The middle joint of the leg that allows the leg to bend. For example: *The baby was crawling around on its hands and knees.*

18. Night/ Knight

Night: The part of the day. For example: *I could not sleep well last night.*

Knight: A man given a rank of honour by a British king or queen. For example: *He hopes to be made a knight for his work at the Bank of England.*

19. One/ Won

One: Number 1. For example: *This book costs one hundred and fifty rupees.*

Won: To be the most successful in a competition, race, battle, etc. For example: *India won twenty-two gold medals in Commonwealth Games 2022.*

20. Peel/ Peal

Peel: Loud sound. For example: *The comic show left us into peals of laughter.*

Peel: To take off the skin. For example: *Carefully peel the apple.*

21. Plain/ Plane

Plain: Simple not showy. For example: *The interior of the church was plain and simple.*

Plane: A flat and level surface, a new level, an airplane. For example: *The plane took off an hour late.*

22. Pray/ Prey

Pray: To offer prayer to God. For example: *She prayed to God for an end to her sufferings.*

Prey: Hunt or kill. For example: *The lion attacked and killed its prey.*

23. Pour/ Pore

Pour: To dispense liquid from one container into another. For example: *I poured it carefully, still I spilt some.*

Pore: A small opening in skin. For example: *Pores are all over our bodies.*

VOCABULARY: Homonyms, Homophones and Homographs

MODULE: I

24. Rain/ Reign

Rain: The water that falls from the sky. For example: *In India agriculture depends mainly on rainfall.*

Reign: Supremacy, rule. For example: *In the field of classical music, Tansen still reigns supreme.*

25. Some/ Sum

Some: A part of something. For example: *There's some cake in the kitchen if you'd like it.*

Sum: Totality. For example: *She was paid the mind-boggling sum of ten million pounds for that film.*

26. Stair/ Stare

Stair: Step. For example: *How many stairs are there up to the second floor?*

Stare: To gaze. For example: *He stared blankly at the paper in front of me.*

27. Tail/ Tale

Tail: A part of animal's body. For example: *The cat's tail was peeping out from under the bed.*

Tale: Story. For example: *My father told us some interesting tales about his childhood.*

28. Viper/ Wiper

Viper: A small poisonous snake. For example: *When I started my new job, I didn't realize that I was walking into a nest of vipers.*

Wiper: A windshield wiper. For example: *One of our wipers is stuck.*

29. Wail/ whale

Wail: Cry. For example: *There's no point wailing about something that happened so long ago.*

Whale: A large sea animal. For example: *A whale was thrashing the water with its tail.*

30. Weigh/ Way

Way: Route. *Infectious disease can be acquired in several ways.*

Weigh: To measure somebody or something in weight. *I weighed the benefits of the plan against the risks involved.*

Homographs

"A word that is spelt like another word but has a different meaning from it, and may have a different pronunciation, for example bow /bau/, bow /bəʊ/." (Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary).

1. **Bow** /bau/: To bend your head or body forward to show respect. *He bowed low to the assembled crowd.*

/bəʊ/: A knot with two curved parts and two loose ends. *I tied the ribbon around the present in a pretty bow.*

2. **Brass** /bræs/: A musical instrument made of a metal tube bent into a particular shape. *The trumpet and the trombone are brass instruments.*

/bra:s/: a bright yellow metal made from copper and zinc: The door handles were made of brass.

3. **Content** /kən'tent/ Happy or satisfied. *Pedro was content with his life.*

/'kɒn.tent/ The ideas that are contained in a piece of writing, a speech, or a film. *This program includes inappropriate content.*

4. **Desert** (/dezət/): An area, often covered with sand or rocks. *They were lost in the desert for nine days.*

/di'zɜ:t/ To leave. *The soldiers, who deserted the battle ground, were caught and shot.*

5. **Entrance** /'en.trəns/: A door, gate, etc. *There are two entrances - one at the front and one*

SEMESTER: ODD

MODULE: I

VOCABULARY: Homonyms, Homophones and Homographs*around the back.**/ɪn'tra:ns/: Captivate. He has entranced millions of people with his beautifully illustrated books.*

6. **Minute** /maɪ'nju:t/: Extremely small. *The documentary showed an eye operation in minute detail.*

'mɪn.ɪt/: 60 seconds (noun). It takes me 20 minutes to get to work.

7. **Read** /ri:d/: To look at words or symbols and understand what they mean. *Read this passage carefully.*

/red/: past tense of 'read.' I read a new book yesterday.

8. **Lead** /li:d/: To go with or in front of a person or an animal to show them the right direction. *I have asked Manoj to lead the discussion.*

/led/: Coloured material, usually black and made of graphite, in the centre of a pencil. The pencil fell off and its lead was broken.

9. **Tear** /teər/: to pull or be pulled apart, or to pull pieces off. *A couple of pages had been torn out of the book.*

/tɪər/: A drop of salty liquid that flows from the eye. Did you notice the tears in his eyes when he talked about his mother?

10. **Wind** /wɪnd/: A current of air moving. *There isn't enough wind to fly a kite.*

/waɪnd/: to turn or cause something to turn. She wound the handle but nothing happened.

Reference:

1. Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary.

2. Cambridge Dictionary.

3. Thesaurus by Merriam-Webster

